



Personal Financial Literacy & Money Management

Family Overview · Optima Academy Online

~4¼ hrs per week · ~50 min/day · semester

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. More topics, scenarios, and projects are approved for this course than appear here, so scholars may see some variation in topics, scenarios, and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

ABOUT THIS COURSE

A required Florida semester course on managing money and making sound financial decisions. Scholars cover earning, budgeting, saving, credit, investing, insurance, and risk — and finish with a personal-finance capstone tied to their own life plan.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

Unit 1 — Foundations of Personal Financial Decisions Decision-making, needs vs. wants, behavioral economics, and cognitive bias.	Weeks 1–2
Unit 2 — Earning Income & Exploring Careers How income works, careers, paychecks, and taxes.	Weeks 3–4
Unit 3 — Budgeting & Smart Spending Building a budget and making smart spending choices.	Weeks 5–6
Unit 4 — Saving & Banking Banking basics, savings strategies, and accounts.	Weeks 7–8
Unit 5 — Credit & Borrowing Credit scores, loans, interest, and borrowing wisely.	Weeks 9–10
Unit 6 — Investing & Building Wealth Investing basics, retirement, and long-term planning.	Weeks 11–12
Unit 7 — Risk Management & Insurance Insurance types and managing financial risk.	Weeks 13–14
Unit 8 — Capstone & Final Personal Finance Capstone Project and final assessment.	Weeks 15–16

Capstone & projects. Unit 8 is a personal-finance capstone (Life Plan Builder + writing assignment) plus a final assessment.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- One or two lesson pages framing the week's concept.
- An applied activity or scenario challenge (e.g., "Investment Portfolio Challenge").
- A VR activity at Optima's VR campus (e.g., VR Investment Booths, VR Risk Maze).
- A reflection assignment and a unit assessment at the end of each unit.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes per week (master schedule)

- Lesson reading & video: ~15 min/day
- Scenario / project work: ~25 min/day
- VR or reflection / quiz: ~10 min/day

Project and capstone weeks may run longer.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- Optima's VR headset (provided) for VR booths and simulations
- Microsoft 365 / OneDrive account
- Microphone for voice-based work
- Reliable internet

On-Demand vs. Live. On-Demand (asynchronous): self-paced with due dates for pacing; a teacher is available for support, feedback, and grading. **Live school:** live-school scholars take the same course in Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates (daily for core courses). **Note.** This course satisfies Florida's required financial-literacy graduation requirement.